

#26 - Walk-through Rock - Paper - Scissors

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Game flow:

1. The user makes a choice
2. The computer makes a choice
3. The winner is displayed.

Pseudocode (Informal)

Given a collection containing rock, paper and scissors strings

□ Ask the user to choose one.

→ save to user-choice

□ Implement a random choice for the computer

→ save to computer choice

□ Compare the two choices

→ if user == rock and computer == scissors

- User wins

if user == scissors and computer == paper

- User wins

if user == paper and computer == rock

- User wins

→ repeat the if statements above with computer winning

→ else it's a tie.

□ Ask the user if they would like to play again.

Formal Pseudocode

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START

Given a collection of strings: 'rock', 'paper', 'scissors'
assigned to constant "VALID_CHOICES"

PROMPT Function defined as: prompt(message)

Provide a clear indication of the outputs from the program
PRINT(==> {message})

END FUNCTION

PROCESS Function defined as: display_winner(player, computer)

Outputs the winner based on the player and computer
choices

IF (player chooses 'rock' AND computer chooses 'scissors') OR
(player chooses 'scissors' AND computer chooses 'paper') OR
(player chooses 'paper' AND computer chooses 'rock'):
CALL prompt("you win")

ELIF (same as IF but swapping player and computer)
CALL prompt("computer wins")

ELSE

CALL prompt("it's a tie")

END IF

END FUNCTION

WHILE True

CALL prompt("Choose a move")

GET user choice

SET user choice to user-choice

WHILE user-choice not in VALID_CHOICES

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CALL prompt("choice not valid, try again")

SET user-choice = user input

END WHILE

SET computer-choice = random value from VALID-CHOICES

CALL prompt("Your choice" + user-choice + "computer choice" + computer-choice + ".")

CALL display-winner(user-choice, computer-choice)

WHILE True

CALL prompt("ask user to play again? (y/n)")

SET answer = user input

IF answer starts with 'y' or 'n':

BREAK

CALL prompt("Enter a valid response.")

IF answer[0] == 'n':

BREAK

END WHILE

END PROGRAM

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Starting to Code

- activate environment that has pylint installed
- create file name rock-paper-scissors.py
- implement `prompt` function to standardise outputs

```
def prompt(message):  
    print(f"=> {message}")
```

Write code that asks user to choose one of: rock, paper or scissors. Add the code below the `prompt` function.

```
prompt('Choose one: rock, paper, scissors')  
choice = input()
```

```
while choice not in ['rock', 'paper', 'scissors']:  
    prompt("That's not a valid choice")  
    choice = input
```

better to assign
this list to a
constant to
make it more
readable

The while loop continues looping until the user enters a valid choice i.e., continue looping if the list does not contain the user's input.

✓ Extract the list `['rock', 'paper', 'scissors']` out and assign it to a constant.

```
VALID_CHOICES = ['rock', 'paper', 'scissors']
```

NB: SUGGESTION - SAVING
CODE for constants.

This should be inserted at the top of the program.

Now we can use `VALID_CHOICES` rather than writing out the list whenever requiring the elements.

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Amending the code to include the `VALID_CHOICES`

```
prompt('Choose one: rock, paper, scissors')
choice = input()
while choice not in VALID_CHOICES:
    prompt("That's not a valid choice")
    choice = input()
```

Could also
use `VALID_CHOICES`
here as well

An advantage of assigning the list to a constant, it allows us to add more choices to the list without having to add those choices to every section of code that relies on the list.

```
prompt(f"Choose one: {', '.join(VALID_CHOICES)}")
choice = input()
```

delimiter

String interpolation and `join` method used to display the options for the player to choose from.

The `join` method concatenates the list of strings. Without the delimiter `" , "`, the concatenation would appear as `rockpaperscissors`. Instead it appears as `rock, paper, scissors`.
space after ,

• Making a choice for the computer we can use the `random.choice` method. Firstly, need to import the `random` module as `random.choice` is not automatically available in Python. `choice()` method returns a randomly selected element from the sequence.

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```
import random
```

```
# code omitted
```

```
prompt(f'Choose one: {", ".join(VALID_CHOICES)}')  
choice = input()
```

```
while choice not in VALID_CHOICES:
```

```
    prompt("That's not a valid choice")
```

```
    choice = input()
```

```
computer_choice = random.choice(VALID_CHOICES)
```

Now, inform the user of what the two choices are:

```
# code omitted
```

```
computer_choice = random.choice(VALID_CHOICES)
```

```
prompt(f"You chose {choice}, computer chose {computer_choice}")
```

Now, time to determine who the winner is:

```
prompt(f"You chose {choice}, computer chose {computer_choice}")
```

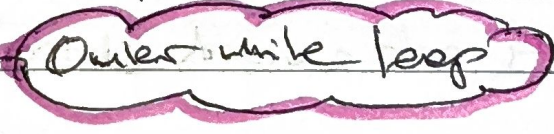
```
if ((choice == "rock" and computer_choice == "scissors") or  
    (choice == "scissors" and computer_choice == "paper") or  
    (choice == "paper" and computer_choice == "rock")):
```

```
    prompt("You win")
```


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```
elif ((choice == "rock" and computer_choice == "paper") or  
      (choice == "paper" and computer_choice == "scissors") or  
      (choice == "scissors" and computer_choice == "rock"))  
    prompt("Computer wins!")  
else:  
    prompt("It's a tie!")
```

All that is needed to be added is providing the user with an option to play again. Below is the full code

```
import random  
  
VALID_CHOICES = ["rock", "paper", "scissors"]  
  
def prompt(message):  
    print(f"=> {message}")  
  
while True:   
    prompt(f'Choose one: {f" , ".join(VALID_CHOICES)}')  
    choice = input()  
  
    while choice not in VALID_CHOICES:  
        prompt("That's not a valid choice.")  
        choice = input()  
  
    computer_choice = random.choice(VALID_CHOICES)  
  
    prompt(f'You chose {choice}, computer chose {computer_choice}')
```


This can be extracted out and incorporated into a function

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```
if ((choice == "rock" and computer_choice == "scissors") or  
    (choice == "scissors" and computer_choice == "paper") or  
    (choice == "paper" and computer_choice == "rock")):  
    prompt("You win!")
```

```
elif ((choice == "rock" and computer_choice == "paper") or  
      (choice == "paper" and computer_choice == "scissors") or  
      (choice == "scissors" and computer_choice == "rock")):  
    prompt("Computer wins!")
```

```
else:
```

```
    prompt("It's a tie")
```

```
while True:
```

inner while loop

```
    prompt("Do you want to play again (y/n)?")  
    answer = input().lower()
```

```
    if answer.startswith('y') or answer.startswith('n'):
```

```
        break
```

breaks out

of inner while loop

```
    else:
```

```
        prompt("That's not a valid choice")
```

```
    if answer[0] == 'n':
```

```
        break
```

breaks out of outer while loop

while True loops continue until a break statement is encountered by the program.

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Extracting the if statements into a function: Insert function below `prompt` function (or above, it does not affect the program).

```
def display_winner(player, computer):  
    prompt(f"You chose {choice}, computer chose {computer_choice}")  
  
    if ((player == "rock" and computer == "scissors") or  
        (player == "paper" and computer == "rock") or  
        (player == "scissors" and computer == "paper")):  
        print(f"Player wins!")  
    else:  
        prompt("It's a tie!")
```

Insert `display_winner` call below the declaration of `computer_choice`

```
computer_choice = random.choice(VALID_CHOICES)  
  
display_winner(choice, computer_choice)
```

FINAL CODE.

```
import random  
  
VALID_CHOICES = ["rock", "paper", "scissors"]  
  
def prompt(message)  
    print(f"==> {message}")  
  
def display_winner(player, computer)  
    prompt(f"You chose {player}, computer chose {computer}")  
  
    if ((player == "rock" and computer == "scissors") or  
        (player == "paper" and computer == "rock") or  
        (player == "scissors" and computer == "paper")):  
        print(f"Player wins!")  
    else:  
        prompt("It's a tie!")
```


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```
(player == "paper" and computer == "rock") or  
(player == "scissors" and computer == "paper")):  
    prompt("You win!")  
elif ((player == "rock" and computer == "paper") or  
      (player == "paper" and computer == "scissors") or  
      (player == "scissors" and computer == "rock")):  
    prompt("Computer wins!")  
else:  
    prompt("It's a tie!")
```

```
while True  
    prompt(f'Choose one: {"", ""}. join(VALID_CHOICES)')  
    choice = input()
```

```
while choice not in VALID_CHOICES:  
    prompt("That's not a valid choice.")  
    choice = input()
```

```
computer_choice = random.choice(VALID_CHOICES)
```

```
display_winner(choice, computer_choice)
```

```
while True:
```

```
    prompt("Do you want to play again (y/n)?")  
    answer = input().lower()
```

```
    if answer.startswith('n') or answer.startswith('y'):  
        break
```

```
    else:
```

```
        prompt("That's not a valid choice.")
```

```
if answer[0] == 'n':  
    break
```


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Implementing the `display_winner` function allows for greater readability of the main section of code and also allows for easier maintainability.

Things to Consider

1. `display_winner` function can be either below (as we did) or above the `prompt` function despite the fact that `display_winner` invokes the `prompt` function. As long as all functions are defined prior to being invoked. i.e., `prompt` function is not invoked by the `display_winner` function until the main code runs and invokes the `display_winner` function.
2. If the intention of the `display_winner` function is to return a string, opposed to outputting the string directly.
 - Would implement a `return string` to the `display_winner` function rather than invoking the `prompt` message
 - Invoke the `display_winner` function within `print` function.
`print(display_winner(choice, computer_choice))`
3. We used a `while True` loop for asking the user if they would like to play again. Alternatively, we could use a conditional `while` loop.

```
answer = ""
```

```
while not (answer.startswith('y') or answer.startswith('n'))  
    prompt("Would you like to play again (y/n)?")  
    answer = input().lower()  
    if not (answer.startswith('y') or answer.startswith('n'))  
        prompt("Provide a valid response.")
```


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NB: Using `startswith` method allows for checking an empty string, whereas implementing `answer[0]` will return an error if `answer = ""`.

i.e.,

```
answer = ""
```

```
if answer[0] == 'n':  
    print(True) # IndexError: string index out of range.
```

```
answer = ""
```

```
if not (answer.startswith('y') or answer.startswith('n')):  
    print(True) # True
```